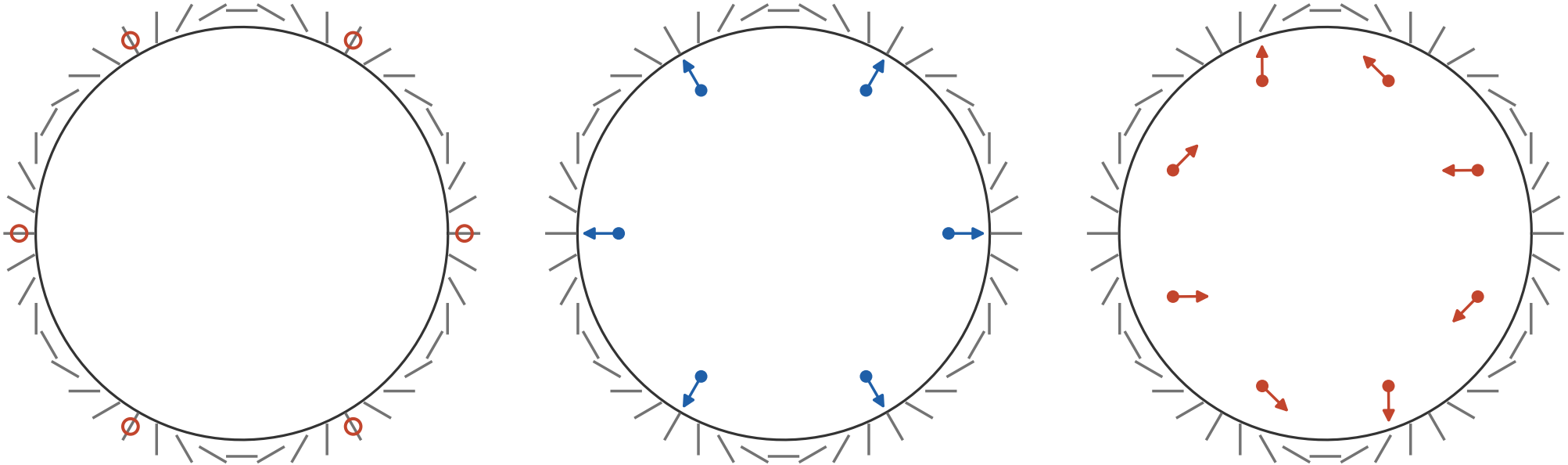
(a) Anchoring, $k = 4$:
6 homeotropic points

(b) Active ring of 6:
all untilted on the sites

(c) Passive ring of 8:
tilts wind, cannot all vanish